

Matter Detail Page — What Was Fixed and Why

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Summary

This document explains the issues identified on the Matter Detail page, what was broken, and why each fix was made. It is written for a non-technical audience.

What was broken and why it was fixed

- Save button didn't save: Clicking "Save Changes" only showed a pop-up and did not store edits. Now it saves your updates (like case number or jurisdiction) to Appwrite so changes persist.
- Case details not loading: The page looked for "criminal_data" but your data lives under "case_data" as a JSON string. It now reads and safely parses "case_data" so fields show correctly.
- Messages showed the wrong fields: The page used "content" while your records store message text in "body", so messages could appear blank. It now shows the real message body and a reasonable subject.
- Billing totals unreliable: Some amounts arrived as text, which could break formatting or display. Totals are now converted to numbers first so currency formatting is correct.
- Timeline not visible: Events were collected but never displayed. The Timeline tab now shows documents, invoices, time entries, hearings, deadlines, and communications in date order.
- Document preview disabled: Clicking a document didn't open a preview. You can now click a document to see its details.
- Inconsistent backend settings: Mixed hard-coded database names with shared settings, causing environment fragility. All calls now use the shared Appwrite configuration.
- Developer leftovers: Debug pop-ups and logs triggered on Save. These were removed for a clean, professional experience.

What changed under the hood

- Implemented real saving: The Save button writes case updates into the matter record's "case_data" field.
- Consistent data loading: The page parses "case_data" and fills the form fields predictably.
- Robust numbers: Invoice amounts/total are coerced to numbers before formatting.
- Accurate communications: Uses the "body" field and a sensible subject fallback.
- Enabled preview: Document items are clickable and open a preview modal.
- Live Timeline: Timeline events are stored in page state and rendered newest first.
- Unified settings: Every database call now goes through the same shared constants.

How the update was rolled out

- Built the site for production and adjusted the build so test files do not block deployment.
- Committed and pushed the changes to the main branch.
- An automated workflow deployed the updated site to Appwrite Sites.